PROactive PRONUNCIATION

"SCHWA" /ə/ in the word "THE"

The word "the" will be reduced to schwa "thuh" as long as the next word does not start with a vowel. If the next word begins with a vowel, you can use the "thee" pronunciation.

Examples:

the book:	"thuh"	the cookie:	"thuh"	the author:	"thee"
the day:	"thuh"	the owl:	"thee"	the end:	"thee

Let's Practice:

all the way out
at the end of the day
begs the question
but in the meantime
by the way
don't pass the buck
for the most part
get to the point
going off the grid
face the music
have to bite the bullet
he kicked the bucket
he paved the way
he's all over the place
he's on the run
he's the cock of the walk
he's under the weather
I call the shots
I'm on the fence
I'm on the job
in the face of fear
it's all the time
it's in the air
it's in the making
it's off the hook
it's on the ground
it's the law of the land
just toe the line
let's clear the air
let's just cut to the chase
on the spot
off the beaten track
on the contrary
on the go
on the other hand
one and the same
out of the blue
out of the way
over the counter meds
seize the day
she let the cat out of the bag
she made the cut
she's dressed to the nines
shooting the breeze
state of the art
that's beyond the pale
that's out of the question
that's over the top
the end
the only one
under the hood
we're on the same page
what a pain in the neck
you're on the ball

The other situation in which "the" is pronounced as "thee" is when you might emphasize something. E.g. "that is **theeeee** best!"

Phrases:

You're the best
I'm going to the store
That's the one I wanted
I laughed so hard at the movie last night